Zdeněk **Kasner**

Freelance AI Consultant · Lecturer · Curious person

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About me

I got interested in language models before they became *large*. Then I've spent some time researching how to make them better. Now I help people to take full control of them in their AI tools and systems.

What can I offer

I can help with the following:

- Consultations on local AI deployment.
- Technical workshops on open AI models.
- Popularization lectures on AI.

I am registered as self-employed (IČO: 06845762) and can issue invoices for my services.

Public outreach

I run a Czech website on open AI models *Lokální.AI*. I write blogposts, publish a newsletter, and run a community Discord server.

Skills & Knowledge

Computer Science · Python · NLP · Machine Learning · LLMs · AI

Languages

Czech

English

French

Dutch

Work & Research

since 10/2026 — **Local AI Specialist**
Freelancer, Lokální.AI — Czechia
Helping institutions and bussiness run open-weight AI solutions locally using open AI models. Consulting, analysing, and implementing solutions.

from 09/2024 to 09/2026 — **Postdoctoral Researcher**
Faculty of Mathematics and Physics, Charles University — Prague, Czechia
Research on large language models (LLMs): controllable text generation and evaluation under the ERC grant NG-NLG (Next-Generation Natural Language Generation).

from 09/2019 to 09/2024 — **PhD Researcher**
Faculty of Mathematics and Physics, Charles University — Prague, Czechia
Research on data-to-text generation with neural language models.

from 02/2023 to 05/2023 — **Research Intern**
Mila – Quebec AI Institute — Montréal, Canada
Research on LLM agents for web navigation, advised by Siva Reddy.

from 01/2019 to 09/2019 — **Software Developer & Researcher**
Robot Perception Group, CIIRC CTU in Prague — Prague, Czechia
Natural language understanding for an automated production line and a collaborative robotic workspace.

from 06/2018 to 09/2018 — **Research Intern**
KDDI Research, Inc. — Saitama, Japan
Developing an augmented reality annotation system.

from 07/2016 to 08/2017 — **Software Developer**
AI Center, FEE CTU in Prague — Prague, Czechia
Implementing a search engine with intermodal routing for public transport.

from 04/2015 to 07/2016 — **Software Developer**
CESNET — Prague, Czechia
Developing a module for device classification in a high-throughput system for network traffic analysis (NEMEA).

Teaching & Lecturing

since 2026 — **Neural Language Models (NI-NLM)**
FIT CTU — Prague, Czechia
A new elective course from scratch: teaching lectures and labs.

since 2025 — **Computational Creativity**
Didaktikon UK — Prague, Czechia
Interactive workshop for primary and secondary schools.

from 2024 to 2026 — **Large Language Models (NPFL140)**
MFF UK — Prague, Czechia
Assisting with lectures and assignments.

from 2023 to 2025 — **Introduction to Machine Learning with Python (NPFL129)**
MFF UK — Prague, Czechia
Lab teaching.

2022 — **Introduction to Linux (NSWI177)**
MFF UK — Prague, Czechia
Lab teaching (inverted class: no lectures).

2020 — **Programming I (NPRG030) & Introduction to Algorithms (NPRG062)**
MFF UK — Prague, Czechia
Lab teaching, preparing and evaluating assignments.

Certificates

Certificate of Proficiency in English (C2)
Cambridge Level 3 in ESOL International

Volunteering

Board of European Students of Technology (2014 – 2019)
Communication and cooperation with students of European universities of technology, organizing courses and engineering competitions.

Organizer

- **DGT Summer School Luxembourg**, 2025
  Co-organizer, speaker
- **PracticalD2T Workshop** @ INLG 2024
  Co-organizer
- **PracticalD2T Workshop** @ INLG 2023
  Main organizer
- **SIGDIAL & INLG 2023**
  Local organizer

Awards

- **Best short paper** at INLG 2025 (Onderková et al., 2025)
- **Joseph Fourier Prize** organized by French Embassy in Prague, 2nd place (2025)
- **Honorable mention** CU Grant Agency award (2023)
- **Outstanding reviewer** at EACL 2021
- **Best short paper** at INLG 2020 (Dušek and Kasner, 2020)

Education

from 10/2019 to 09/2024
PhD in Computational Linguistics
Faculty of Mathematics and Physics, Charles University — Prague, Czechia
- **Thesis:** Domain Adaptation for Natural Language Generation
- **Advisor:** Ondřej Dušek

from 07/2016 to 06/2019
Master in Artificial Intelligence
Faculty of Electrical Engineering, Czech Technical University in Prague — Prague, Czechia
- **Thesis:** Incorporating Language Models into Non-autoregressive Neural Machine Translation
- Dean award & minor degree in Computer Vision

from 09/2017 to 02/2018
Erasmus+
Katholieke Universiteit Leuven — Leuven, Belgium
Courses from Master of AI.

from 09/2013 to 06/2016
Bachelor in Computer Science
Faculty of Information Technology, CTU in Prague — Prague, Czechia
- **Thesis:** Flow-Based Classification of Devices in Computer Networks
- Graduated with honors

Selected Publications

2026
Zdeněk Kasner, Vilém Zouhar, Patrícia Schmidtová, Ivan Kartáč, Kristýna Onderková, Ondřej Plátek, Dimitra Gkatzia, Saad Mahamood, Ondřej Dušek, and Simone Balloccu, "LLMs as Span Annotators: A Comparative Study of LLMs and Humans", in *Proceedings of the 2026 Workshop on Multilingual Multicultural Evaluation, co-located with EACL 2026*, 2026.

Zdeněk Kasner, and Ondřej Dušek, "AnimatedLLM: Explaining LLMs with Interactive Visualizations", in *Proceedings of 2026 TeachingNLP Workshop, co-located with EACL 2026*, 2026.

Danil Semin, Ondřej Dušek, and Zdeněk Kasner, "Strategies for Span Labeling with Large Language Models", *arXiv:2601.16946*, 2026.

2025
Kristýna Onderková, Ondřej Plátek, Zdeněk Kasner, and Ondřej Dušek, "FreshTab: Sourcing Fresh Data for Table-to-Text Generation Evaluation", in *Proceedings of the 18th International Natural Language Generation Conference*, 2025.

2024
Xing Han Lu, Zdeněk Kasner, and Siva Reddy, "WebLINX: Real-World Website Navigation with Multi-Turn Dialogue", in *Proceedings of the ICML 2024*, 2024.

Zdeněk Kasner, and Ondřej Dušek, "Beyond Traditional Benchmarks: Analyzing Behaviors of Open LLMs on Data-to-Text Generation", in *Proceedings of the ACL 2024 (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, 2024.

Zdeněk Kasner, Ondřej Plátek, Patrícia Schmidtová, Simone Balloccu, and Ondřej Dušek, "factgenie: A Framework for Span-based Evaluation of Generated Texts", in *Proceedings of the 17th International Natural Language Generation Conference (System Demonstrations)*, 2024.

2023
Zdeněk Kasner, Ekaterina Garanina, Ondřej Plátek, and Ondřej Dušek, "TabGenie: A Toolkit for Table-to-Text Generation", in *Proceedings of the ACL (Volume 3: System Demonstrations)*, 2023.

Zdeněk Kasner, Ioannis Konstas, and Ondřej Dušek, "Mind the Labels: Describing Relations in Knowledge Graphs With Pretrained Models", in *Proceedings of the EACL 2023*, 2023.

2022
Zdeněk Kasner, and Ondřej Dušek, "Neural Pipeline for Zero-Shot Data-to-Text Generation", in *Proceedings of the ACL 2022 (Volume 1: Long Papers)*, 2022.

2021
Zdeněk Kasner, Simon Mille, and Ondřej Dušek, "Text-in-Context: Token-Level Error Detection for Table-to-Text Generation", in *Proceedings of the INLG 2021*, 2021.

2020
Ondřej Dušek, and Zdeněk Kasner, "Evaluating Semantic Accuracy of Data-to-Text Generation with Natural Language Inference", in *Proceedings of the INLG 2020*, 2020.

Zdeněk Kasner, and Ondřej Dušek, "Data-to-Text Generation with Iterative Text Editing", in *Proceedings of the INLG 2020*, 2020.

Zdeněk Kasner, and Ondřej Dušek, "Train Hard, Finetune Easy: Multilingual Denoising for RDF-to-Text Generation", in *Proceedings of the INLG 2020 (WebNLG+ Workshop)*, 2020.

Zdeněk Kasner, Jindřich Libovický, and Jindřich Helcl, "Improving Fluency of Non-Autoregressive Machine Translation", *arXiv:2004.03227*, 2020.